



## Android Extensions

Google is currently working on "Android Extensions" to make updates less painful. <http://dgit.in/AExtG>

## Windows differential patching

Windows is switching to differential patching in the Creators Update to bring smaller downloads and quicker update checking. <http://dgit.in/windpCU>

Bazaar

# Zebronics Max

## The most affordable gaming mechanical keyboard

**M**echanical keyboards are expensive and most of them are priced above ₹8k. Cherry MX switches have been the standard when it comes to mechanical keyboards. But we're seeing knock off switches such as Kailh, Outemu and Gateron, making their way into the market that drastically lowers prices. The announcement of the launch of Max was indeed surprising, mostly because of the shockingly low price of just ₹2.4k.

The Max is a Ten-Key Less(TKL) size keyboard so there's no numpad. On the bottom you have a hard plastic base with rubber lined on all four feet. Having rubber feet ensures that the keyboard doesn't slide away from you while typing. The metal frame housing the keyboard has a matte finish which is quite sturdy without any flex. The open design also makes it easier to reach all the keys while cleaning the keyboard. It has double-shot injection moulded keycaps, and as we subjected it to a lot of scratching, the font didn't wear off except for the bottom icons on the top row keys. The keycaps are compatible with Cherry MX keys, so you'll be able to swap them out with different accented keycaps. It has a braided USB cable of about 1.8m in length, with velcro straps for cable management if you have a small workspace. On the left, you have an LED indicator panel for the Scroll and Caps Lock, and the illuminated Zebronics logo. It would be nitpicking, but they could have removed the panel since the Scroll and Caps Lock keys already toggle on and off according to their state. This would have further reduced the length of the keyboard.

The Max uses Outemu Blue clear switches which are similar to Cherry's Blue switches. Fundamentally, the colour across mechanical switches depicts similar functionality so the Outemu Blue should have the same tactile feel similar to Cherry MX Blues. The differences are considerable, especially the harder actuation force and the louder, clicky noise. While the Cherry MX Blue has an actuation force of 50g, the Outemu Blue registers a click at about 60g, and both have the same travel distance of around 4mm. It feels more tactile to type, the only downside being it's louder than its Cherry equivalent. The higher actuation force could also be a letdown for many users. On Typert-



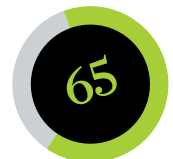
Price  
₹2,424

acer, we were able to hit a maximum of 79 words per minute (the average being about 85) with an average accuracy of 94.33%. This wasn't on the first try though, since it took time to get familiar with the layout and key switches. It all depends on the previous keyboard you were using, factoring in the distance between every key and also getting used to the missing numpad.

The switches have a single LED colour, with each row having a different colour on the keyboard. The clear switch type used on Cherry encloses the LED light inside but in this case, the clear Outemu switches have the LED light placed on the outside. The lights are immensely bright and the keycaps are translucent enough to diffuse the light to a favourable brightness level. Using the combination of the function key, you'll be able to toggle between the normal and breathing mode for the lights, along with three brightness levels.

One huge concern that might bother users looking for a budget mechanical keyboard would be the absence of the numpad, you'll often find mechanical keyboards in this segment not having one in order to save money. If you're accustomed to using the numpad frequently, then you might find yourself out of place, and it will require some time to get used to with the small form factor. Another thing to consider is the use of Outemu switches instead of the industry standard Cherry MX switches. For its price, currently it falls right above the Cherry MX Blue TVS-e Gold keyboard. Comparatively, the build quality and backlit LEDs are strong points for you to consider buying this keyboard over the Gold. Considering the cons mentioned above, if you wish to go mechanical for the first time on a seriously tight budget, then you should definitely go for the Max.

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Features .....62  
Build Quality .....66  
Value .....80

## Specifications

**Keyboard size:** Ten-Key Less, Numpad missing;  
**Keyboard backlighting:** Multi-coloured LED;  
**Switch type:** Mechanical keyboard (Outemu Blue);  
**Key-rollover:** 10-key rollover; **Polling rate:** 1000Hz

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